An Escape That Did Not Set Me Free.

A By-Product of Morgan's Raid.

Lieut.-Col. David Hastings Moore, 125th O. V. I.

Commander and Companions:



T was in the summer of 1863, before Grant had taken Vicksburg, or Lee had been defeated at Gettysburg. The draft had been declared and—January 1, 1863—Mr. Lincoln had issued the Proclamation of Emancipation. Important elections were pending in Ohio. Intense opposition to the war had developed. Sympathy with Secession was open and defiant. Oath-bound organizations were armed and drilled. Treasonable badges were flaunted. In some places children were forbidden by the school authorities to wear Union colors. Recruiting was most difficult. Companies were harder to raise than regiments had been. Meetings for volunteers were molested; men inclined to enlist were subjected to protest and intimidation. Union speakers were annoyed; harness was cut on their horses; and here and there fortifications were thrown up and garrisoned to resist the draft. From New York, thro Pennsylvania, Ohio and Indiana, Knights of the Golden Circle were organized, apparently only awaiting an opportunity to raise the flag of Rebellion on Union soil.

Is it any wonder that General John Morgan, with such an inviting prospect of warlike Knights flocking to his standard, enabling him to rescue the thousands of valiant Confederate soldiers imprisoned in Fort Morton, Indianapolis; to arm and equip them from plethoric Union arsenals, and with ever augmenting numbers sweep on to Camp Chase in Columbus, Ohio; rescue and arm the thousands there; and being joined every hour by the anti-union hordes, to push resistlessly on through Pennsylvania, effecting a junction with Lee; who, thus mightily strengthened, would toss Meade out of his path, seize Washington and make it the new capital of the victorious Confederacy—is it any wonder, I repeat, that Morgan ignored his orders to confine his operations to Kentucky, made the Ohio his Rubicon, and risked all on a scheme as grand as ever glittered in the mind of a Cæsar?

There were dangerous possibilities in the audacious undertaking. And those who gave it promise, and could have made the promise reality, those fire-eating Knights, refused the hot diet when it was offered, and lured the daring invaders to their doom. And yet, tho